

Feeling Pain

Although unpleasant, pain is a useful warning sign that something isn't right with the body and that we need to act quickly to avoid further injury.

Pain signals

Pain receptors are located all over the body and respond to heat, cold, overstretching, vibration, and chemicals released by wounds. Electrical signals are sent from the site of injury to the spinal cord, where they cross over and travel to the opposite side of the brain to the injury. If sudden, strong pain is experienced, a reflex reaction occurs (see p.101) within the spinal cord to make the limb pull away from whatever is causing the pain, even before we are aware of it.

WHO FEELS THE MOST PAIN?

Women feel pain more intensely than men because they have more nerve receptors in their bodies.

